

Short-Form Series Template Database

The below is from the Series & Scriptwriting system in [Short Form Academy](#). Short Form Academy is Kallaway's private program designed to help business owners build social media content machines that drive leads & sales.

If winning on social media and growing your personal brand is a priority for you in 2026, and you want help from Kallaway personally, we have a few spots open. [LEARN MORE \(limited availability\)](#)

Overview: Each series type below includes its definition, top-performing examples, the per-episode storytelling strategy, the outlier secret sauce, and a plug-and-play episode template you can copy.

The Top 6 Series Formats:

1. Numbered Countdown / Challenge
2. Progress Journey
3. Recurring Educational Segment
4. Case Study / Breakdown
5. Docuseries
6. Skit Universe

1. Numbered Countdown / Challenge

Description: Series with a stated count or fixed endpoint — “Lesson 28 of 30,” “Day 14 of 259,” a 30-day challenge — where each episode delivers one self-contained unit toward a known, publicly declared total.

Examples:

- (Lessons Countdown) @chloe.shih — 30 Lessons by 30
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DF0OukRGsh/>
- (Daily Count) @house.of.ag — Day 14 of 259
 - https://www.instagram.com/reel/DX5Xz1_pASX/
- (Fixed-Length Course) @mafeanzures — Pre-Influencer Bootcamp, 30-day
 - <https://www.tiktok.com/@mafeanzures/video/7578983059563810078>
- (N-Day Challenge) @marie_mag_ — Day 37 of 75
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DDcaql6uW1C/>
- (Challenge Finale) @kohisocial — Project 30, Day 30/30
 - <https://www.tiktok.com/@kohisocial/video/7309094630593662213>
- (Countdown Series) @becstewart__ — New Year Prep, Episode 1
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reels/DBnbVTMSaJb/>
- (Numbered Parts) @valerie_lisitsyna — Monetizing, Part 9
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DRBQA5hkYr/>

Starting Point: A declared finish line: a set number of lessons, days, or episodes you commit to publicly.

Script / Storytelling Strategy:

- Hook (pull from Hooks Database: lead with the payoff, not the number)
- Episode-number stamp (drop “Lesson 28” / “Day 14” early to signal the series)
- Series promise (one line on what the full journey delivers)
- Single-unit value (teach ONE thing fully, don’t dilute across the count)
- Proof or stat (validate the problem is shared, not just yours)
- Save-able takeaway (a named framework, checklist, or tool)
- Loop close + next-episode tease (“This is X of Y, next one’s tomorrow”)

Secret Sauce (To Make An Outlier)?

- The count creates an open loop the algorithm rewards daily. Viewers follow so they don’t “miss” a finite thing.
- Lead with the emotional/result hook, NOT the number. The count is the spine, not the bait.
- Each episode must stand alone AND compound. Complete by itself, but a clear step in the larger arc.
- Tie each unit to a time peg (a holiday, a season) so a templated series still feels live.

Plug And Play Mad-Lib Templates:

1. **HOOK** - Lead with the stakes, not the count.
 - **Template:** “The most [adjective] mistake I made was [behavior].”
 - **Template:** “This is why you need to [action] if you want [outcome] in [year].”
2. **STAMP** - Locate the episode in the series.
 - **Template:** “Lesson [N] of [total].”
 - **Template:** “Day [N] of [total] of [series promise].”
3. **PROMISE** - Re-sell the whole journey.
 - **Template:** “Welcome to [series name], a [duration] series where I teach you [big outcome].”
 - **Template:** “[N] [units] to help you [transformation].”
4. **UNIT** - Deliver one complete idea.
 - **Template:** “Today we’re talking about [single topic], because [why now].”
 - **Template:** “Here’s the one thing about [topic] nobody tells you.”
5. **PROOF** - Validate it’s universal.
 - **Template:** “[Stat]% of people [shared problem].”
 - **Template:** “99% of [audience] make this mistake, the 1% [do the opposite].”
6. **LOOP** - Save + return.
 - **Template:** “Screenshot this. This is [series name]. Next lesson’s tomorrow.”
 - **Template:** “Come back tomorrow for [episode N+1].”

2. Progress Journey

Description: *Open-ended documentation of one big goal or mission carried across episodes with no fixed finish line — “until I hit X,” a long rebuild, saving something. Each episode is a dated checkpoint in a pursuit the audience roots to see completed.*

Examples:

- (Until-Goal) @brock11johnson — review a Reel daily until 1M
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DYvcfBeBFjI/>
- (Mission / Build) @yohnmav — Saving My Local Bowling Alley
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DV8uM8ujZYP/>
- (Long Rebuild) @thegrowthconsultant_ — 61-Day Launch & Rebuild
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DNYqNgMtjJC/>
- (Open-Ended Day Count) @ashtonhallofficial — “Day 2,020 of being an entrepreneur”
 - <https://www.tiktok.com/@ashtonhallofficial/video/7572365210942491934>
- (Lifestyle Mission) @ashtonhall — “Day 1 of a simple life as an entrepreneur”
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DUd5BeDktik/>
- (Build-From-Scratch) @alidasbakery — building a bakery from nothing
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DMAzEnbRhHX/>

Starting Point: A public commitment to one ambitious, hard-to-fake mission, counted day by day.

Script / Storytelling Strategy:

- Lead-with-value or striking-visual open (give a reason to watch before the series framing)
- Day-stamp the mission (“Day 110... until I hit 1M”) to signal stakes and history
- Show today’s concrete proof of momentum (the task done, the wall torn out)
- Tie back to the why (the goal, the emotional stakes)
- Tease what’s next (a collaborator, an upcoming reveal)
- Participation CTA (“follow to see it come to life” / “comment to be featured tomorrow”)

Secret Sauce (To Make An Outlier)?

- The day number is the hook AND the most prominent visual in the first two seconds. It instantly signals a high-stakes ongoing series.
- Pick a mission with a real-world finish line outside your control, so each episode carries genuine suspense.
- Bake in a recurring participation mechanic so the audience becomes a character, not just a viewer.
- Use before / archival footage to prove the baseline and make progress legible.

Plug And Play Mad-Lib Templates:

1. **DAY-STAMP HOOK** - Anchor the episode in the mission.
 - Template: “Today is day [number] of [mission].”
 - Template: “Day [number] of [action] until I hit [goal].”
2. **VALUE DROP** - Give a standalone reason to watch.
 - Template: “[Quick tip or result the viewer can use today].”
 - Template: “Starting with [today’s concrete task].”
3. **STAKES & HISTORY** - Remind why it matters.
 - Template: “For [number] years, [thing] has been [state].”

- **Template:** “I’m doing this because [emotional reason].”
- 4. PROOF OF PROGRESS** - Show today moved the needle.
- **Template:** “Today I [specific action completed].”
 - **Template:** “Here’s win number [X] from day [number].”
- 5. THE TEASE** - Pull viewers to the next episode.
- **Template:** “I’m gearing up for something [epic descriptor].”
 - **Template:** “[Collaborator] is about to pull up to help me [task].”
- 6. PARTICIPATION CTA** - Convert viewers into returning participants.
- **Template:** “Follow to see [outcome] come to life.”
 - **Template:** “Comment [thing] to be featured in day [number+1].”

3. Recurring Educational Segment

Description: A series with no story arc and no fixed end: the same opening, banner, and format repeat every episode while the payload is a fresh standalone tip, idea, or hack. The audience returns for the reliable container, not a continuing narrative.

Examples:

- (Weekly Hack) @ginnyfears — Instagram hack you didn’t know about
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/CMZ6a7ujmpt/>
- (Named Segment) @juliabroome — Plannuary
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DTYqsQ8krAj/>
- (Numbered Episodes) @businesssecretsclub — Reel ideas, Episode 10
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/C6k-NOUMr1K/>
- (Daily Tips) @madisonknowsbest — daily growth tips
 - <https://www.tiktok.com/@madisonknowsbest/video/7493581433655659807>
- (Daily Ideas) @shannonmckinstrie — daily Reel ideas
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DHePaYjSJw9/>
- (Weekend Series) @businesssecretsclub — Reel tutorial, Episode 48
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DPs3B8PDBGc/>
- (Tool Series) @marketingharry — ChatGPT prompts series
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/Cv1SN15ttvn/>
- (Spotlight Series) @rico.incarnati — Creators Crushing It
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DKPTxnCR19-/>
- (Resource Series) @itsmodernmillie — Brands That Pay
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/CZAKoq1BmrU/>

Starting Point: A repeatable teaching format wrapped in a named, branded banner that signals “you’ve been here before.”

Script / Storytelling Strategy:

- Signature open (a countdown, sound, or stock phrase that’s the same every time)
- Series re-announce (name the banner — “Welcome back to ____”)
- Today’s payload (one episode’s standalone tip)
- Result first (show the outcome before the how)
- Step-by-step delivery (low-friction, screen-recorded or templated)
- “Why it works” beat (earn authority, not just instructions)
- Loop-closing CTA (save + “come back next week”)

Secret Sauce (To Make An Outlier)?

- A fixed format signature is the moat: same intro device, banner, and layout every time, so the brain recognizes the series in under two seconds and watching becomes a habit.
- Number or episode-stamp the content ("Part 1," "Episode 10") to imply an archive and train binge + return behavior.
- Self-contained value per episode. No prerequisite to watch, infinite runway to make more.
- Show the result immediately, then teach the mechanism. Desire before instruction.

Plug And Play Mad-Lib Templates:

1. **SIGNATURE OPEN** - Trigger instant recognition.
 - Template: "[Recurring stock phrase], part [number]."
 - Template: "[Countdown or beat-drop] + [text value prop]."
2. **SERIES TAG** - Re-announce the series.
 - Template: "Welcome back to [series name], where I [promise]."
 - Template: "Episode [#] of [series name]."
3. **PAYLOAD** - Name today's standalone tip.
 - Template: "Today we're [planning / fixing / hacking] your [topic]."
 - Template: "This week's [idea / hack] is [one thing]."
4. **RESULT-FIRST PROOF** - Show the outcome before the how.
 - Template: "You can [impressive result]. Here's what I mean..."
 - Template: "When I say [specific claim], this is what it looks like..."
5. **THE HOW** - Deliver low-friction steps.
 - Template: "Go to [exact location] and [action]."
 - Template: "Step one, [do X]; step two, [do Y]."
6. **RETURN LOOP** - Close the habit loop.
 - Template: "Save this and come back for [next episode / part]."
 - Template: "Follow so you don't miss [next drop]."

4. Case Study / Breakdown

Description: A recurring analytical format where the creator-as-analyst applies one fixed evaluative lens to a brand-new subject each episode. Dissecting why a brand, creator, or product is winning (or losing) so the audience can steal the playbook.

Examples:

- (Either / Or Lens) @orenmeetsworld — Product or Brand?
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DSQcN5Vko-T/>
- (Creator Breakdown) @itsryanto — Creator Marketing
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DM75MN5R8LS/>
- ("Doing X Right") @house.of.ag — Brands Doing Marketing Right: All Things Butter
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/C54mkAQ5oW/>
- (Numbered Breakdown) @jtbarnett — Art & Science of Influencers
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DQZfE2nj8bm/>
- (Good vs Bad) @thesortedgirl — Good Content vs Bad Content: Gin

- <https://www.instagram.com/p/C7TCtCII6Rn/>
- (Good vs Bad) @house.of.ag — Good Content vs Bad Content: Coffee
 - https://www.instagram.com/reel/DS_YKEaCTvu/
- (“Doing X Right”) @house.of.ag — Brands Doing Content Right: Gant
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DFQF-sfpPST/>
- (Predictions Lens) @brian_blum — 2026 Marketing Predictions
 - https://www.instagram.com/reel/DSFvmr_DiRy/

Starting Point: One repeatable lens (a framework, a “doing X right” claim, or a numbered breakdown), with a fresh subject plugged in each episode.

Script / Storytelling Strategy:

- Stake the claim (bold verdict + name the subject)
- Establish authority (drop a hard metric or origin story as proof)
- Name the lens (the framework you’ll judge by)
- Run the breakdown (1-3 specific factors with evidence)
- Counter the obvious (the contrarian “here’s what’s actually going on”)
- Project forward (what they should / will do next)
- Series CTA (tie to the recurring series + invite the next subject)

Secret Sauce (To Make An Outlier)?

- Make the FRAMEWORK the brand, not the subject. “Product or Brand?”, “Doing Marketing Right”, so each new subject reloads the same satisfying lens.
- Pair the verbal analysis with constant high-stimulus B-roll of the subject (greenscreen over their footage) so the eye is fed while the brain learns.
- Take a polarizing stance and invite disagreement. Comments compound the outlier.
- Always end on a transferable lesson, not just praise. Viewers share what they can apply.

Plug And Play Mad-Lib Templates:

- SUBJECT REVEAL** - Name the case study.
 - **Template:** “This is [subject] and here’s why they’re [winning / losing] at [area].”
 - **Template:** “Are you buying the [product] or the [brand]? [Category].”
- PROOF DROP** - Validate with a number or origin.
 - **Template:** “After [metric / result], here’s how they did it.”
 - **Template:** “It started as [origin] and became [outcome].”
- LENS** - State the framework.
 - **Template:** “There are [number] things they’re doing really well.”
 - **Template:** “I judge everyone in this space by one question: [lens].”
- BREAKDOWN BEAT** - Dissect a factor.
 - **Template:** “Number one, they [specific tactic] and that signals [meaning].”
 - **Template:** “The thing is, they don’t [obvious move], they [real move].”
- CONTRARIAN TURN** - Subvert the assumption.
 - **Template:** “Everyone thinks [common belief], but actually [contrarian reality].”
 - **Template:** “This whole category is [verdict].”
- SERIES CTA** - Loop to the next episode.

- **Template:** “I break down [series name] every week. Comment who I should do next.”
- **Template:** “Weigh in on [subject] in the comments.”

5. Docuseries

Description: A personality-driven series where each episode is a self-contained chapter of the creator’s own ongoing arc, opened with a signature ritual and a recurring host / persona, so the audience returns for the story, not just a tip.

Examples:

- (Creator Docuseries) @tianaveeee — *Digital Diaries, Episode 10*
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DNOyQwTJkD/>
- (Branded Playbook Show) @omgadrian — *The Full Time Creator Playbook*
 - <https://www.tiktok.com/@omgadrian/video/7544168270224559415>
- (Ritual-Led Show) @itsmodernmillie — *Content Creator Thoughts*
 - <https://www.instagram.com/p/DNTJvk6ON57/>
- (Signature-Format Show) @subwaytakes — *Subway Takes, Episode 585*
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DSVDWPvDvoD/>
- (Signature-Format Show) @subwaytakes — *Subway Takes, Episode 407*
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DLNE2H3M01v/>
- (Prop-Anchored Show) @maxklymenko — *Career Ladder (UK edition)*
 - <https://www.tiktok.com/@maxklymenko/video/7573450891156655382>
- (Street Show) @alanthedude — *Guess Where You’re From*
 - <https://www.tiktok.com/@alanthedude/video/7575623111287131414>
- (Creative Docuseries) @joshlouie.jpg — *Makin’ Fun Lil Things*
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DVPherRkox4/>

Starting Point: A real, in-progress life arc (a pivot, a climb, a body of work) worth documenting episode by episode under one branded show name.

Script / Storytelling Strategy:

- Signature cold open (a recurring ritual / visual that says “the show is back”)
- Stakes hook (a relatable grievance or contrarian fact tied to your arc)
- Show ID + recap (“This is [series], where I...”)
- Episode promise (the specific chapter / lesson today)
- Lived-experience body (2-3 beats of real experience, not generic tips)
- Humanizing beat (an off-script aside that proves it’s a person, not a brand)
- Open-loop outro (“let’s see how this goes” / next-episode tease)

Secret Sauce (To Make An Outlier)?

- A repeatable signature opening is the show’s title card — the coffee brew, the “same time, same place,” the “this episode of ____.”
- Season-long arc beats: each episode references a prior one and advances the story, turning viewers into subscribers to an outcome.
- One recurring persona and one world: fixed voice, framing, and setting build parasocial loyalty across episodes.
- Vulnerability is the currency: real failure (rejection, burnout, broke) is the throughline that makes the “show” feel earned.

Plug And Play Mad-Lib Templates:

1. **COLD OPEN** - Re-establish the show via ritual.
 - Template: "Welcome back to [show name]."
 - Template: "[Doing signature ritual], so let's talk about [today's chapter]."
2. **STAKES HOOK** - Justify the episode emotionally.
 - Template: "Now that [negative reality] is so bad, I might as well [risky pivot]..."
 - Template: "Have you ever wondered how [audience] go from [pain] to [outcome]?"
3. **SHOW ID + RECAP** - Anchor in the arc.
 - Template: "This is [series name], where I share [premise]."
 - Template: "Last episode, [recap]; now [new development]."
4. **EPISODE PROMISE** - Set today's payload.
 - Template: "Here are [number] ways I'm going to [goal]."
 - Template: "Today I'm showing you [specific lesson]."
5. **LIVED-EXPERIENCE BODY** - Prove it with your story.
 - Template: "[Number]: [theme]. For me, that looked like [personal example]."
 - Template: "What I went through was [raw detail], not [polished version]."
6. **OPEN-LOOP OUTRO** - Guarantee the return.
 - Template: "Let's see how this goes."
 - Template: "New episode every [day]. Same time, same place."

6. Skit Universe

Description: Recurring fictional character(s) and a fixed cast perform scripted comedic scenes inside a consistent world; the situation changes each episode while a single repeatable comedic engine drives every payoff.

Examples:

- (Branded Social-Show Skit) @bkcoffeeshop — café skit, Episode 81
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DYXYFJHNm0u/>
- (Numbered Office Skit) @renshawjay — "Chit" office series, Episode 7
 - <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/CCJhrnc3YFk>
- (Corporate-Character Skit) @arjunpandeyhere — Workload of HR Department
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DL2RosyoV4W/>
- (Startup Office Skit) @cluely — office series, recurring "Brandon"
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DO4WD7IkiHs/>
- (Corporate Cast) @clickupcomedy — recurring ClickUp office cast
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DTN-f7bk-U6/>
- (Office Series) @renshawjay — "Chit" office series (IG)
 - <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DKuhQb5JoYo/>

Starting Point: A defined cast and a familiar location (café, office) that returns episode after episode, so the audience arrives already knowing the rules.

Script / Storytelling Strategy:

- Re-establish the world (recurring character enters the recurring setting)

- Plant the conflict line (a provocative or high-stakes opening line)
- Run the engine, beat 1 (the show's signature comedic contrast)
- Escalate the same engine (repeat the pattern, bigger and sillier)
- Peak the tension (push the misunderstanding / contrast to its most absurd point)
- Snap reveal (the mundane or innocent truth lands)
- Button exit (a final twist or in-character tag that resets the world)

Secret Sauce (To Make An Outlier)?

- The comedic ENGINE is fixed, not the joke. One mechanism (jargon vs. reality, edgy projection vs. normal) yields infinite episodes.
- Named recurring cast in named roles make episodes feel serialized and build familiarity that compounds views.
- Deadpan protagonist + high-energy reactors: the oblivious lead never breaks while side characters validate the audience's shock.
- Repetition with escalation: each beat reuses the same structure, training viewers to anticipate (and crave) the next reveal.

Plug And Play Mad-Lib Templates:

1. SETUP - Re-establish the recurring world.

- **Template:** "[Recurring character] walks into [recurring setting] and [inciting line]."
- **Template:** "We open on [cast] mid-scene as [character] starts [routine situation]."

2. PROVOCATION - Drop the tension line.

- **Template:** "[Character] says '[provocative / ambiguous statement].'"
- **Template:** "[High-stakes question], [character] asks, and the room freezes."

3. ENGINE BEAT - Run the signature contrast.

- **Template:** "[Character] frames [trivial thing] as '[inflated / edgy version].'"
- **Template:** "They expect [edgy assumption], but the truth is [mundane reality]."

4. ESCALATION - Repeat the engine, bigger.

- **Template:** "[Other character] doubles down with '[even more absurd version].'"
- **Template:** "Beat two: [trivial task] gets dressed up as '[grander claim].'"

5. REVEAL - Snap to the mundane truth.

- **Template:** "Turns out [character] just meant '[plain explanation].'"
- **Template:** "[Witness] reveals it was actually [embarrassingly simple truth]."

6. BUTTON - Tag and reset the world.

- **Template:** "[Character] exits with '[in-character twist line].'"
- **Template:** "[Recurring character] delivers [signature catchphrase] as the scene cuts."